AI TRAINING PROGRAM · EXECUTIVE TRACK

Artificial Intelligence for Executives

Applied AI for Executives across industries: a private programme, one-to-one or in small groups, built around your company and your own work.

Nick Gushchin — Applied AI practitioner · Building · Transforming · Educating

4 years in applied AI: AI transformation, AI products and agents, AI education

Zurich, Switzerland

WHO IT IS FOR

Executives across industries / Who it is for

The method is the same everywhere: understand the technology, use it yourself, then lead it in your organisation. Examples and exercises come from your sector.

Manufacturing & industrial
Industrial groups, engineering

Supplier contracts, quality and service reports, technical documentation, plant and machine data.

Financial services
Banking, insurance, asset management

Credit files, research digests, regulatory reading, client preparation.

Professional services
Consulting, legal, audit

Proposals, due diligence, reuse of the firm's own knowledge.

Retail & consumer
Retail, consumer goods, e-commerce

Customer insight, assortment and pricing analysis, marketing content at scale.

Healthcare & pharma
Life sciences, hospitals, medtech

Literature review, regulatory and medical writing, all under strict data rules.

Technology & telecom
Software, IT services, telecom

Product strategy, AI-assisted engineering, customer operations and support.

Public sector & education
Administration, universities, schools

Policy drafting, services for citizens and students, procurement under transparency rules.

Another sector?
The approach transfers

We start from the tasks on your desk and the decisions you own.

Who takes part: CEOs, board members, managing directors and Executives who run business lines or functions such as finance, operations, risk, HR, sales and IT. No technical background needed.

WHO RUNS THE PROGRAMME

Your Trainer / a practitioner, not a staff trainer



Nick Gushchin

Applied AI practitioner
Building · Transforming · Educating
Zurich, Switzerland

4 years in applied AI

110K users of his AI chatbot

20+ AI tools and agents built

- **Transforming** — leads AI transformation in a Swiss industrial group, taking AI from pilots to production. Earlier: AI strategy and governance for banks in Switzerland and Germany, and Chief AI Advisor for generative AI in discrete manufacturing.
- **Building** — his own AI products and agents: an AI chatbot used by 110,000 people, a local-AI app for iPhone, iPad and Mac, and a personal AI agent that runs much of his daily work.
- **Educating** — applied AI lecturer at Digicomp Academy and in public masterclasses on AI agents. Founder of Head of AI Club Zurich, a roundtable for the people who run AI inside their companies. Mentor at Young AI Leaders Zurich Hub (ITU AI for Good).
- **Speaker** — guest lecture at ETH Zurich, .NET Day Switzerland, Swiss Data Conference, AgentCon, GenAI Zurich.

EDUCATION

ETH Zurich — AI, Data & Machine Learning · current

London Business School — Executive MBA, with distinction

Chicago Booth

BACKGROUND

Before AI: 18 years in international corporate banking and trade finance. The programme sits where business practice, AI transformation and hands-on AI building meet.

OUTCOMES

Expected Deliverables / what you leave with

The minimum result of the programme. Agreed in the first session and adjusted by you as we go.

01

Your personal AI stack

Personal effectiveness

- AI in your daily work: meeting preparation, documents, analysis, writing
- The leading tools, and how to brief them for your context
- How AI works and where its limits are
- Gains you can measure: time, quality, money

PROOF
Your real tasks get done faster and better, on your own material.

02

Leading adoption

Leadership

- Working with AI yourself and through your team
- One shared language with IT, data, risk and legal
- Lessons from successful and failed roll-outs
- Governance: data, control, compliance, accountability

PROOF
Your pilot proposal survives the first questions from risk, legal and IT.

03

Strategic judgment

Decisions and investment

- Is AI needed here? ROI and risk of an AI project
- Build vs buy, open vs closed, vendor vs in-house
- Lasting trends, separated from the news cycle
- The effect of AI expressed in your P&L

PROOF
You can size the real effect of a project before the budget is approved.

How every session works: your own material · data rules settled before the hands-on part · proven patterns from other industries.

STRUCTURE

Program Structure / three tracks

From understanding AI, to using it yourself, to leading it in your organisation. Running through all three: AI agents, infrastructure and data security, and cases from your industry.

1 · Foundations

HOW AI REALLY WORKS

- **From AI to LLMs**
  How models are built and trained, and why "train it on our data" rarely means what you think
- **Hallucinations and bias**
  Properties of the architecture, not bugs
- **The AI economy**
  Chips, cloud, platforms, models: where the margin and the lock-in sit
- **Where your data lives**
  Open vs closed models; public service, company tenant or local model
- **Model security**
  Prompt injection, retention, logging, training rights

2 · Applied AI

YOUR OWN WORK, HANDS-ON

- **Leading tools**
  ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Perplexity and others: scenarios and how to choose
- **Briefing AI**
  Context, decomposition, examples, structured output, checking the result
- **Your tasks**
  20 sources into a one-page brief, comparing contract versions, meeting notes into actions, data and spreadsheets
- **Your personal AI stack**
  Notes, research and agents working together

3 · Enterprise AI

AI IN YOUR ORGANISATION

- **Where the value is**
  Copilots, AI on company knowledge (RAG), vertical AI, autonomous workflows
- **Architecture and deployment**
  Models, data, access rights, integration, monitoring
- **Governance**
  Data classification, EU AI Act, vendor risk, auditability
- **Failure modes**
  Overestimated maturity, missing data, ignored process and users
- **What comes next**
  Multi-agent systems and vertical AI

CROSS-CUTTING THEME / AGENTIC LAYER

From chat to agents / the agentic layer

The difference between asking a model and handing it a task. An agent plans steps, calls tools and works between those steps without a human. That brings real gains and a new class of operational risk.

What an agent is

ASSISTANT · TOOL · AGENT

- **Assistant**
  Answers a request; context lives in the conversation
- **Tool**
  A fixed function: a search, a calculation, a system query
- **Agent**
  Plans its own sequence of steps and calls tools to reach a goal
- **The price of autonomy**
  More steps without direct oversight, hence requirements for rights, limits and logging

Personal level

PERSONAL AGENTS

- **Research**
  A pool of sources into a structured brief on a client, competitor or market
- **Monitoring**
  News, reports and events in your field, without checking sources by hand
- **Documents and email**
  Sorting, summaries, draft replies and follow-ups
- **Your workspace**
  Notes, files, calendar and search linked into one flow

Enterprise level

ENTERPRISE AGENTS

- **Multi-step processes**
  Gathering a case file, reconciling data, preparing a decision pack
- **Orchestration**
  Planning, memory and calls into internal systems, within access rights
- **Human in the loop**
  Designed into the architecture, with fixed checkpoints
- **Observability**
  Step traces, cost per run, quality drift over time

An agent is not a smarter model: it is a model plus tools, rights and the ability to act. The rights you grant set both the gain and the risk, so they are decided before the pilot. Today's mature pattern: the agent prepares, a person approves.

FORMATS

Formats / three ways to work together

The same programme in every format. Materials, exercises and questions between sessions are included.

Private sessions

1-ON-1 · 1–2 PEOPLE

- **From CHF 250 per hour**, 1 hour a week
- The programme adapts fully to you and your role
- Flexible pace and focus, set by your priorities
- Exercises and regular work with AI between sessions
- Online or in person in Zurich
- **Best for** an Executive who wants to become fluent personally, fast

Executive AI Deep Dive

UP TO 5 EXECUTIVES · 3 HOURS

- **60 min · How modern AI works**
  Limits, hallucinations, what it means for your decisions
- **75 min · Practice on your tasks**
  Every participant brings a real one and gets it solved
- **45 min · Adoption and governance**
  First steps, data questions, preparing the pilot
- **Best for** a leadership team that wants a shared start; can run as a series

In-house lectures

3–15 PEOPLE · FROM 2 HOURS

- A focused session on one theme: foundations, agents, governance or adoption
- Examples drawn from your industry and company
- At your premises or online
- **Best for** a wider leadership group that needs the same picture of AI

Focus and emphasis are set in the first session and adjusted as the programme runs.

NEXT STEP

Getting started in three steps

Let’s learn and apply AI together

01

A short call
20 minutes

Your goals, your current level and the priorities for the programme.

02

Your plan
and schedule

Focus by track, format, number of sessions and dates that fit your calendar.

03

First session
on your material

We start with a real task from your own work.

Availability. The programme is run by a practising specialist, not a staff trainer, so the number of sessions per month is limited. Dates depend on current commitments and are confirmed in advance.

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